the commander of the air force was left in the dark. In other words, the right hand did not know what the left hand was doing. And don't let us forget: Netanyahu's personal theory was that Hamas was not interested in conflict but sought merely an improvement of material conditions in the enclave. If this was the well-informed opinion at the top, why should the civilian and military services be worried? The initial Yom Kippur disaster, on October 6, 1973, stemmed from a massive failure of the various intelligence services; the disaster on October 7, 2023, seems to be due to a similar failure. And these are Israel's most highly praised agencies!

Possibly worse: after their parents were killed, two small children from the kibbutz Be'eri, ages six and eight, hid in a closet and phoned relatives in the central part of the country to ask for help. It took these relatives twelve hours to organize a rescue. Friends and civilians with small arms and maps volunteered to drive to the kibbutz and liberate the children. Civilians! Not a single soldier in sight! The army was nowhere to be seen!

General David Petraeus, the retired commander of US troops in Iraq and Afghanistan, says that Israel's challenge in Gaza is much worse than what the US had to face after 9/11. He warns that troops entering the densely populated enclave would have to face a highly hostile and unpredictable environment, where each room could be packed with explosives, where endless tunnels had been dug and could be full of Hamas terrorists, and so on.

When I get depressed by events and the growing hatred all around, I cannot help thinking that I started in life, in the 1930s and 1940s, under the cloud of antisemitism and that I am coming to the end under a cloud of hatred against the Jews. I know perfectly well that the two situations cannot be compared, but what does rational thinking help in moments like these?

On the other hand, what one hears regarding Netanyahu and his people can only serve to enrage. Apparently an order has come from his office not